

LADY VICTORIA
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Before You Book the Venue

The Essential Multicultural Wedding Checklist

MULTICULTURAL VENUE GUIDE



START HERE

Ask before you *pay the deposit*

A beautiful venue must also support the celebration, décor installation, cultural traditions, guest arrival, and production plan. Use this checklist before paying a deposit.

> BEFORE YOU SIGN
>
> *If a promise affects your ceremony, décor, food, music, parking, guest count, budget, installation, or timeline, request written confirmation in the contract.*

INSIDE THIS CHECKLIST

01	Date, Hours & Curfew
02	Real Capacity & Layout
03	Alcohol, Bar & Certificates
04	Catering & Kitchen Rules
05	In-House Rentals
06	Décor Setup, Load-In & Breakdown Access
07	Power, Rigging & Effects
08	Guest Parking, Valet & Arrival
09	Total Cost & Contract
10	Questions for Multicultural Weddings
11	Before You Sign

01 Date, Hours & Curfew

- [ ] What time may vendors begin load-in, and when must setup be complete?
- [ ] What time must music, alcohol service, guest activity, and vendor load-out end?
- [ ] What overtime fees apply to event time, staff, security, cleanup, or late strike?
- [ ] Is there a local noise ordinance or amplified-sound limit that ends outdoor music earlier than the venue curfew?

02 Real Capacity & Layout

- [ ] What is the realistic seated capacity with tables, stage, dance floor, entertainment, bars, food stations, lounge furniture, and cultural structures?
- [ ] Can the full guest count fit in the weather-backup space?
- [ ] If weather forces a change, by what time must the call be made, and are tents, sidewalls, heaters, or ground flooring permitted?
- [ ] Does capacity change for multiple ceremonies or room flips?

03 Alcohol, Bar & Certificates

- [ ] Does the venue hold the required liquor license, or is a temporary permit needed?
- [ ] Who obtains the permit, licensed bartenders, security, liquor-liability coverage, and certificate of insurance?
- [ ] Must the venue be named as an additional insured?
- [ ] What time must alcohol service end, and what bar fees apply?

04 Catering & Kitchen Rules

- [ ] Is catering exclusive, preferred-list only, or open to outside cultural caterers?
- [ ] May caterers cook on-site, and are tandoors, grills, fryers, woks, propane, refrigeration, water, ice, and waste disposal permitted?
- [ ] Can halal, kosher, Jain, vegetarian, vegan, allergy, fasting, and cross-contact requirements be supported?

05 In-House Rentals

- [ ] Which tables, chairs, linens, tabletop items, bars, staging, dance floors, lounge pieces, and cocktail tables are included?
- [ ] What quantities, sizes, colors, and conditions are guaranteed?
- [ ] Are delivery, setup, breakdown, cleaning, reset, and damage fees included?
- [ ] May the dance floor be wrapped or covered with a custom vinyl wrap or overlay? What adhesive, installation, removal, and floor-protection rules apply, and who is liable for damage to the floor beneath?



06 Décor Setup, Load-In & Breakdown Access

- [ ] Exactly how many hours are allowed for décor setup before guest arrival?
- [ ] Exactly how many hours are allowed for décor breakdown and load-out?
- [ ] Can installation begin the day before, and may décor remain overnight?
- [ ] Is the space on the same level as the loading entrance?
- [ ] Is there a loading dock, same-level entry, ramp, or service entrance for large pieces?
- [ ] What are the freight-elevator interior dimensions, door opening, weight limit, and reservation rules?
- [ ] Can oversized backdrops, stages, floral installations, carts, and rental furniture fit through every door, hallway, turn, and elevator?
- [ ] How far is the loading point from the event space, and are there stairs, narrow corridors, carpet, or guest areas on the route?
- [ ] Are dock times assigned, and can multiple vendors load in together?
- [ ] Where may décor trucks and production vehicles park after unloading?
- [ ] Are union labor, venue engineers, security, or venue staff required?
- [ ] What carts, dollies, lifts, ladders, scissor lifts, forklifts, or pallet jacks are allowed?
- [ ] When must the room be guest-ready, and who approves room release?
- [ ] What happens if access is delayed by the venue or a prior event?
- [ ] What dock, elevator, storage, cleanup, overtime, or late-strike fees apply?
- [ ] Where may boxes, tools, floral buckets, packaging, and production cases be stored?
- [ ] Who performs the final walkthrough, and how are damages recorded?
- [ ] Are real-flame candles permitted (including floating and votive candles), and what glass-enclosure or venue approval rules apply?
- [ ] What may be attached to walls, ceilings, and floors — and are tape, pins, hooks, confetti, loose petals, or sparklers restricted?

07 Power, Rigging & Effects

- [ ] How much electrical power is available for lighting, entertainment, catering, and production, and where are the circuits and outlets located?
- [ ] Are dedicated circuits, a power drop, or a generator required or provided, and what do they cost?
- [ ] May chandeliers, florals, draping, or installations be hung from the ceiling? What rigging points, weight limits, and rigger requirements apply?
- [ ] Are cold-spark machines permitted for entrances and first-dance moments, and what fire-marshal, insurance, or venue approvals apply?
- [ ] Is a low-lying cloud effect (dry ice) permitted for the first dance? What rules apply to dry-ice delivery, storage, and handling, ventilation, and fire-alarm or smoke-detector sensitivity?
- [ ] Is atmospheric haze permitted for lighting and photography effects?
- [ ] If the venue loses power, is there backup power, and what happens to the event?



08 Guest Parking, Valet & Arrival

- [ ] How many guest parking spaces are available?
- [ ] Is parking complimentary, validated, or paid by guests?
- [ ] Is valet required or optional, and what are the fee, minimum, staffing, hours, and gratuity rules?
- [ ] Where are the guest drop-off, accessible drop-off, shuttle, bus, limousine, and rideshare areas?
- [ ] Is overflow parking available, and is a shuttle required?
- [ ] Can vendor vehicles park separately from guests?
- [ ] Are there garage height limits, operating hours, traffic restrictions, or overnight-parking rules?
- [ ] Is the path from parking safe, accessible, and well lit in bad weather?
- [ ] Can a cultural procession occur without blocking valet, guest parking, traffic, or emergency access?

09 Total Cost & Contract

- [ ] Does the quote include rental, service charges, taxes, staffing, security, cleaning, rentals, parking, valet, power, elevators, docks, overtime, and damage deposits?
- [ ] Does the contract list setup and breakdown hours, loading access, parking, curfew, catering, alcohol, weather, and overtime terms?
- [ ] Will every important approval be placed in writing?
- [ ] What deposit and payment schedule does the venue require, and what are the cancellation and postponement terms?
- [ ] What insurance certificates must each vendor provide, and when are they due to the venue?



SECTION 10

Questions for *Multicultural Weddings*

i Multiple Ceremonies & Spaces

- ☐ Can the venue host two or more ceremonies, room transformations, rehearsals, and cultural leaders?
- ☐ Is a prayer, preparation, or ceremonial holding room available?

ii Sacred Fire & Ritual Materials

- ☐ Are sacred fire, incense, oil lamps, candles, smoke, rice, petals, powders, water, oils, and ceremonial foods permitted?
- ☐ What fire-marshal approval, permits, ventilation, protective materials, insurance, cleanup, or staffing are required?

iii Processions & Grand Entrances

- ☐ Can the property support a baraat or other cultural procession, musicians, dancers, animals, or specialty transportation?
- ☐ What route, staging, timing, noise, rain, parking, valet, permit, insurance, and security requirements apply?

iv Attire, Language & Family Needs

- [ ] Are there enough private rooms for attire changes, stylists, family, elders, performers, prayer, nursing, and quiet breaks?
- [ ] Can programs, signs, screens, ceremonies, interpreters, and announcements use multiple languages?

v Extended Timeline & Guest Experience

- [ ] Is the rental window long enough for every ceremony, attire change, meal, performance, photo period, room flip, and rest break?
- [ ] Where will guests wait during transitions, and can refreshments be served?
- [ ] Can décor and ceremonial structures remain overnight with secure storage?

SECTION 11

Before You Sign

- [ ] Request a complete itemized proposal.
- [ ] Walk and measure the décor freight path from the truck to the event space.
- [ ] Confirm setup and breakdown hours in the contract.
- [ ] Confirm guest parking, valet, accessible drop-off, rideshare, shuttle, and vendor parking.
- [ ] Review the venue with your planner, caterer, designer, and entertainment team.



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Lady Victoria Designs provides luxury wedding planning and full-room event design with thoughtful logistics, strong client advocacy, refined aesthetics, and celebrations that honor each couple's priorities and traditions.

Planning a multicultural, multi-ceremony, or culturally detailed wedding? We invite you to schedule a design consultation.

Bring this checklist and your venue contract — we will review the answers with you and help you confirm the venue can support the celebration you are envisioning.

SCHEDULE A CONSULTATION

TEXT	(301) 312-0332
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